

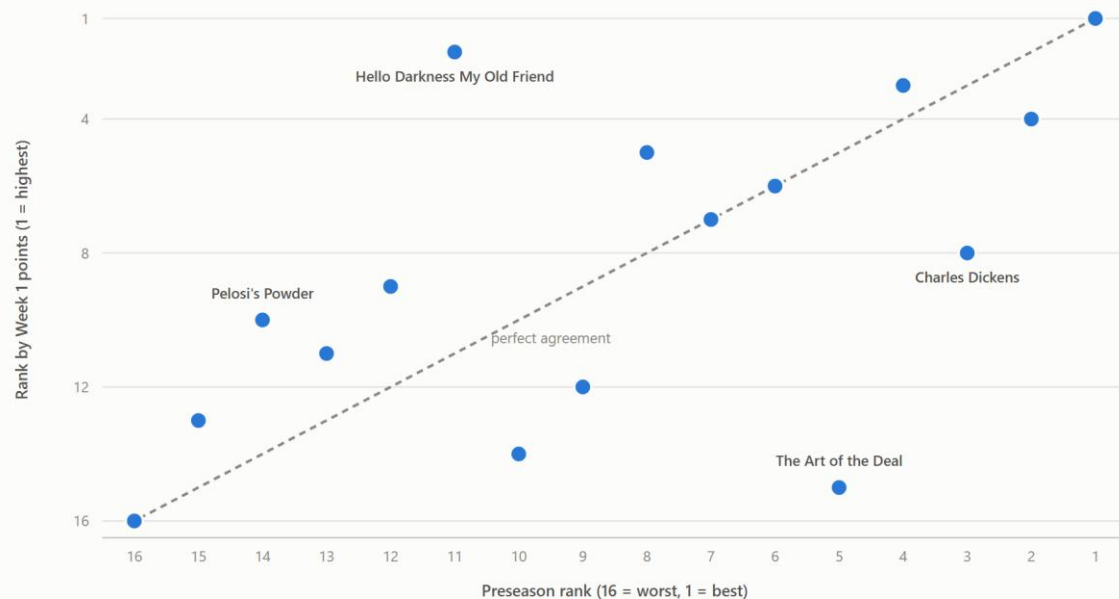
Free Chee Week 2 Rankings 2026

Ready boys? After one week of football, it's becoming clear that the committee is close to perfecting its craft. Using no models, data, or algorithms in the preseason rankings yielded some elite results for week one. While other analysts spent August chasing Mickey Mouse narratives and listening to anonymous training camp reports, the committee relied on intuition, gut feeling and personal bias. The results speak for themselves.

Preseason #1 Boone led the league in scoring in week one. Preseason #16 Work Ass finished last. When comparing preseason rank to projected week one points, the relationship is undeniable. The graph below shows a clear correlation between points scored and preseason rank. Even more so if you remove a couple of the outliers from the dataset.

Preseason rank vs. Week 1 scoring rank

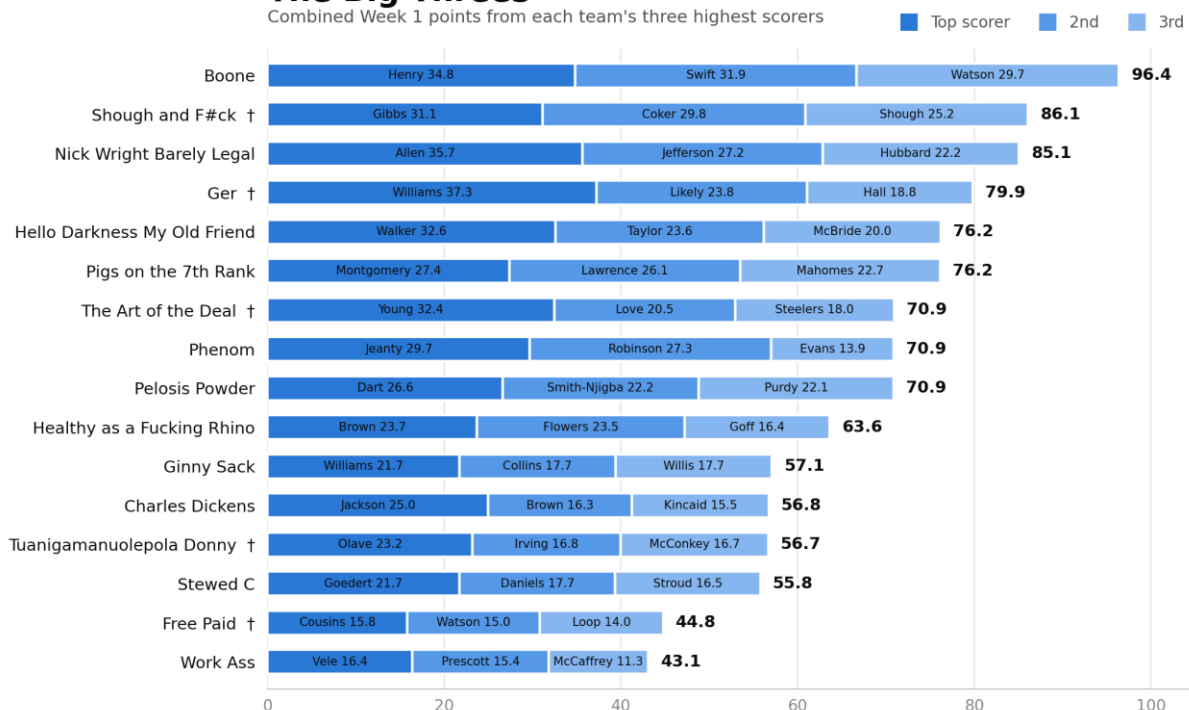
All 16 teams, both axes as ranks, using final Week 1 points. The dashed diagonal is perfect agreement; vertical distance from it is slots moved. Spearman $\rho = 0.59$ (95% CI 0.14 to 0.84).



Detractors may attempt to distract from this achievement by mentioning Art of the Deal or Hello Darkness My Old Friend. The committee considers those examples statistically insignificant and questions why anyone would focus on two isolated data points when the broader trend so clearly supports our expertise. One week is obviously far too small a sample to reconsider any of our preseason opinions, but it is more than enough evidence to declare the opinions we got right completely validated. Now without further ado.

The Big Threes

Combined Week 1 points from each team's three highest scorers



Top three rostered players, started or not.

† one of the three was benched: Young 32.4 (Art of the Deal) · Coker 29.8 (Shough and F#ck) · Likely 23.8 (Ger) · McConkey 16.7 (Donny) · Watson 15.0 (Free Paid)

1. Boone (TJ)

Boone stays on top after another masterful managing performance. He's clearly taking after his namesake this year. Derrick "King" Henry, D'Andre Swift, and Christian "Tom" Watson combined for 96.4 points. For comparison, Work Ass' entire lineup scored 60.4 points. Trying to call off the dogs would have required Boone benching his entire team by halftime. The best part for Boone is he didn't even get the best version of some of his guys. Baker fumbled three times, Pollard is unfortunately part of the Titans (scrambled ass franchise), and Parker "George" Washington was on the bench. Boone's elite offseason program is already paying dividends.

Fact: This team's ceiling is the moon. Boone not only has star power but role-player depth as well.

Fiction: Marvin Harrison Jr. can bounce back. This scumbag might be finished. We're on year three for this supposed "generational" prospect and he still has never caught eight passes in a game. We would trade him straight up for Isaiah Likely or Kyle Monangai.

2. Pigs on the 7th Rank (Deez)

After Mahomes looked healthy in his 1st game back, the committee continued to feel good about Pigs. Mahomes and Trevor "Saint" Lawrence could be the best QB duo in the league this year. David Montgomery apparently decided his move to Houston would be a good opportunity to turn into prime Marshall Faulk and he did all this without Brock Bowers. The receiver duo of DK Metcalf and Brian Thomas Jr does give us cause for concern after a lackluster performance, but we expect them to be adequate going forward. Really the biggest disappointment for Pigs this week was that Shough turned it around in the second half against Detroit. Insider intel from Pigs' war room when Shough was turning it over painted the picture of a team in full celebration, as if they'd just won an election. While the committee is sure many around the league share this sentiment, they will have to wait a little longer to dance on Shough's grave.

Fact: If Josh Jacobs sorts out his legal issues, he is going to be a factor. While some had moral qualms about drafting Jacobs, Pigs didn't hesitate. Morality aside, Marshawn Lloyd and Chris Brooks looked horrendous in week one. If the Packers get Jacobs off the commissioner's exempt list he will certainly return to bellcow status which would be a massive boon for Pigs on the 7th Rank.

Fiction: The two-tight-end strategy is stupid. The committee kind of likes Pigs stacking tight ends. Juwan Johnson looks like a threat and stacking him with Brock Bowers could prove formidable.

3. Ger (Ger)

Ger's team doesn't stink? You heard it here first. He has a serious squad this year. Caleb put up 37 points and might be well on his way to a QB1 overall type of year piloting this ferocious Bears offense. While Caleb led the way, Ger received significant contributions across his lineup including Breece Hall looking like a clear RB1 for the improved Jets and DJ Moore justifying the offseason hype with a big game in his Bills debut. The hot start justified the committee's earlier belief in Ger's revamped operation. He moved his training facility to Charlotte, fired his entire scouting department and spent significant capital bringing in a whole new analytics team. This appears to have yielded not just top-end talent but solid depth as well. Isaiah Likely was here for the game in his Giants debut putting up 23.8 points while Stefon Diggs and Jordan Mason also look like solid depth options. All of this puts Ger's organization in an unfamiliar place as a team to beat going forward.

Fact: Geno Smith is still at risk long term. While we liked what we saw against the Titans, the Titans might be the worst team in the league. So, we can't get too over our skis after one good win, but the hope is that the Jets remain competitive enough to justify Geno starting deep into the season.

Fiction: James Cook won't live up to the hype. Cook had a mediocre week one with just 8.4 points, but we can chalk that up to a stingy Texans run defense. The Bills felt they needed to lean heavily into the deep passing game and Cook's output will improve.

4. Hello Darkness My Old Friend (Zaukas)

Holy Jupiter. What an overhaul from what has historically been a fairly underwhelming franchise (sorry to say). Darkness entered the draft with a new discipline and focus to acquire talent. We don't know if it was all that time in the Florida sun or his new shoulder regimen at the gym, but either way the changes worked. Jonathan Taylor and Kenneth Walker are a monster running-back duo, Trey McBride is like a Rhydon with speed and Burrow will start shredding defenses once September is over. For some reason, he has always despised September. Receiver is definitely a question mark with two elderly gentlemen like Chris Godwin Jr. and Deebo Samuel Sr., but they'll do for now. The committee loves the Jordyn Tyson pickup because that dude can ball. Even if he's not available until week 10, he's got the talent to be a league winner. Between Ger and Zaukas both executing sound roster management, it's like this is a whole new league.

Fact: Aaron Rodgers is washed. Between his frequent dalliances with the Tucker Carlson crew and his near complete immobility, he is a long way from MVP-level Rodgers. This may prevent Darkness from fulfilling his true potential.

Fiction: Evan McPherson will score 19 points every week. Unlikely to happen.

Tier Two

5. Shough and F#ck (Boyle)

Obviously, when the committee faces accusations of bias from godless communists it pains us and makes us want to lean into such accusations. But the committee has too much integrity to let such things affect the sanctity of the rankings. Therefore, Shough and F#ck gets the 5th spot this week. It was a highly competitive race for this spot with several different clubs considered, but the sheer volume of Tyler Shough and Jahmyr Gibbs won out for Shough. Tuten may have been expensive, but we trust the volume he'll get in that explosive Jaguars offense. He's handcuffed Tuten as well to limit the downside and was able to secure Jalen Coker who might just be this year's breakout wide receiver. Much of his

long-term outlook will depend on Shough, but if Shough is a player he'll be in the playoff mix.

Fact: He deserves credit for his bench. The committee has admiration for the mix of talent he picked up at the end of the draft. Lots of guys with potential upside come December.

Fiction: Shough is good at football. Shough may start every game and throw for a million because the Saints' only other option is Spencer Rattler, but even a good version of that looks like 2019 Jameis Winston with 30 touchdowns and 30 interceptions. We'll bet Shough is backing up Dak Prescott in Dallas next year.

6. Nick Wright Barely Legal (TK)

Nick Wright and his luscious locks made a compelling case for being as high as third, but the Tua variable was too much to overcome. Everyone knows the committee loves Josh Allen, but was he kidding this Sunday? Against what many consider the best defense in the league; he went into their house and dropped 36 points on their head. He has been and will remain the most reliable bet in fantasy football. When you pair Allen with the Jefferson/CeeDee combo and what appears to be a trustworthy running game, you've got a real contender on your hands. The trouble is Tua. He appeared to be the starter entering the year but was ruled out late with an oblique injury. Given Tua's injury history, one might question if he plays a game all year. If not, Nick Wright will be in trouble. If Tua does play, this team will be in the inner circle of contenders.

Fact: Alec Pierce is Caucasian. Starting a white wide receiver in the superflex has never been a league-winning proposition in this league.

Fiction: Nick has solved roster construction and proven that QB2 is a liberal myth.

7. Charles Dickens (Mitch)

There was a compelling case to be made that he should remain higher, but the AJ Brown injury ultimately knocked him down a peg or two. Overreliance on the Patriots could prove to be his undoing, but the committee still has faith. Can't overreact to one bad week. Lamar Jackson is back in peak form, Chase Brown is a cow with bells, and Dalton Kincaid is beginning his long-awaited breakout. All of these are strong components of a winning strategy for Dickens. Now for the bad part. Can Drake Maye bounce back without AJ Brown? Damn near the entire tri-state area could hear evil laughter emanating from Connecticut when Brown went down with a high-ankle sprain and the committee questions whether Romeo "No Hands" Doubs can step in as WR1 for the Patriots. Maye will need to lean heavily on Rhamondre and as Charles Dickens once famously wrote, "No one is useless in this world who lightens the burden of another."

Fact: This team will still make the playoffs. There's too much talent here for an AJ Brown injury to keep him out of the top eight.

Fiction: Tyrone Tracy doesn't deserve to be shot. After struggling all preseason, the Giants still managed to give Tracy a couple of touches in Week 1. Tracy squandered that opportunity and immediately fumbled. He'll likely be cut by the Giants and Dickens this week.

8. Ginny Sack (Chris)

Ginny went cheap on QB this year and we like what we're looking at so far. Daniel Jones and Malik Willis will likely be unspectacular but if they can score 12+ each week we expect him to put up points because this skill corps is legitimately nice. Skattebo looked every bit the braindead bowling ball he showed to be at the beginning of last season while rumbling and bumbling through the Dallas defense. On the other side of the field, Javonte Williams looks primed for another big year as Dallas has Onion at backup RB. Nico Collins looked rejuvenated with a motivated Stroud slinging the rock and Jadarian Price showed some juice in a mildly unproductive debut. Between that and the depth, Ginny seems like a solid bet to return to the playoffs.

Fact: Shedeur is less retarded than Deshaun Watson. While this may be like saying I do less Xanax than Ricky, it remains true. And this fact ensures Shedeur will soon become the 3rd starting quarterback on Ginny's roster which is a luxury few teams in the league will have.

Fiction: Daniel Jones can outrun Boyle.

Tier Three

9. Healthy as a Fucking Rhino (Connor)

Rhino kicks off the season with a win for the first time since 2023. In the first matchup of former Monroe compatriots, Zay "Ereck" Flowers and Amon-Ra St. Brown powered Rhino to a big win. He didn't even get big weeks from Omarion Hampton or Travis Etienne and was still able to pull out the win. Sadly, he didn't get to celebrate it too much. Zay Flowers tweaked his hamstring which is always a concerning injury and Rhino's good friend lost a small fortune betting on the Eagles. This led Rhino to spend most of Sunday evening consoling his good buddy about it. If that's not bad enough, he has Cam Ward (again). There's no way to sugarcoat it. Ward is downright horrendous. In what should have been an easy matchup against the Jets, he couldn't muster more than 11 points against the Aaron Glenn defense.

Fact: Cam Ward will finish as QB24 or worse in points per game this year and the Titans will draft his replacement next April.

Fiction: Hampton is cooked. It was a bad week one for sure. But we have too much faith in Harbaugh and McDaniel to abandon ship after one poor game.

10. Phenom (Justin)

Bijan and Jeanty combined for 57 points. Stafford and Darnold combined for 5.6 points. Obviously, Darnold got hurt and credit to Phenom for handcuffing him with Drew Lock. We're willing to give Stafford the benefit of the doubt about the weird Australia game, but his age is something to monitor. The poor QB output likely cost Phenom a win vs Ginny Sack. If anything, the elite Bijan and Jeanty games made us more bullish on this team going forward. Mike Evans also looks like he'll be a reliable starter in his 49ers debut. Credit Phenom for identifying an undervalued veteran. The trouble is the rest of the lineup leaves something to be desired. Tre Tucker is bad at football. Brenton Strange is at best the 4th option for the Jaguars. And Wan'Dale Robinson has to catch passes from Cam "Mickey" Ward. Barring herculean efforts from his top guys, it may prove difficult to become a title contender.

Fact: Bijan might be the best pure football player in the league. Playing with Cooper "The Blind Ogre" Rush, he managed to put up 173 yards from scrimmage. While many commend Gibbs for his work, Bijan's degree of difficulty puts many scholars in awe.

Fiction: Jonah Coleman is ready to contribute (at least for now). The committee was high on Coleman, but watching the Broncos game Monday night, he appears to be buried behind Dobbins and Harvey in Denver's backfield rotation.

11. Pelosi's Powder (Mikey)

Holy Powder. If we trusted the management of this team, he might be even higher. He's got some serious weapons this year. Jaxson Dart looks like a budding franchise QB, Brock Purdy is as sturdy as ever, and the JSN-Nabers duet has serious explosiveness from the receiver position. We can even toss Kyren Williams some praise for his reliability. Beyond that, though, he is starting Travis "Scott" Hunter in the flex and he doesn't really play offense. Terrance Ferguson might be TE4 on the Rams. Woody Marks is a decent player if Montgomery gets hurt, but until then he's a handcuff. In short, Pelosi will need mega-racked performances from his QBs and receivers to churn out victories. Given the history of this team, we question whether the bagmaster strategy can survive the season-long grind. Bagmasters have been known to put up some flashy performances in September and October, but the grind wears them down over the course of the season.

Fact: Dart is a potential superstar. He looked polished executing the new offense but retained much of the running ability that made him so effective last year. If Dart can marry those two facets over the course of the season, he will be dangerous.

Fiction: Travis Hunter was a good pick. He was a bad pick by the Jaguars and a bad pick by Pelosi.

12. Stewed C (Joey)

Doubling down on Commanders with Jayden Daniels and Terry McLaurin is just not something the committee can get behind. Daniels appears to have regressed since his revelatory rookie year. He's skinny, his mom sucks and he stirred up a PR shitstorm in August by beefing with his former college about his number. None of this gives us optimism that Daniels is primed for a big year. And Terry McLaurin did nothing week one to give us confidence in him returning to 2024 form. Marshawn Lloyd "Austin" was expected to provide some serious spark for the Packers in Josh Jacobs' absence, but he looked like your run-of-the-mill Mountain West running back against the Vikings. All of this is bad news for Stewed.

But there is some good news. CJ Stroud looked remarkably sharp, and we like him to have a big year for the Texans. Puka, while limited in his critical thinking skills, has proven to be a stud so we're unconcerned about a slow start in Australia. And Dallas Goedert appears to be one of the big beneficiaries of AJ Brown's departure from Philadelphia. Credit Stewed for knowing. Our fear is none of this will be enough to offset our concerns.

Fact: Cornering the market on secondary Eagles pass catchers (Goedert, Wicks, Lemon) was a sound role player strategy. It's likely at least one of them will become a reliable starter every week.

Fiction: Jayden Daniels is the franchise savior Commanders fans envisioned after his rookie year.

13. Art of the Deal (Matt)

We hate to do it to him, but Art plummets after week one. Kyler immediately getting concussed, Emari Demercado occupying the RB2 spot and Kyle Pitts putting up a goose egg were all bad news for Art. Jordan Love and Bryce Young looked like ballers which is good because it insulates him in the case of a serious Kyler injury. And the committee trusts Achane and Pickens to get back on track in short order. Given the storied history and reliability of Art's franchise, we hesitate to write him off. It doesn't look good at the moment, but we'll be watching closely to see what kind of tricks he has up his sleeve to right the ship in the short term.

Fact: Jordan Love is going to be nasty this year. The Packers defense looks poor, so we expect them to be in a bunch of shootouts this year. Love will have a lot of chances to throw the puck.

Fiction: Quentin Johnston will have a breakout season for the Chargers.

14. Free Paid (Gallo)

After a dominant 2025 regular season in which he rolled to a 13-1 record, he's looking to recreate that magic in 2026. It is not off to a good start. Only one guy (excluding kickers) scored in double figures for Free Paid. And that guy was Kirk "Boogie" Cousins. Saquon? Bad. DeVonta Smith? Worse. Bo Nix? Looked like Gallo trying to evade the Free Cheese employees back in the day. It's only one week but the committee finds it hard to see an avenue where he replicates last year's run. Having said all that, we do expect improvement from the Detroit and Philly guys in his lineup. Philly's fantasy point allocation will not skew away from Saquon and DeVonta Smith every week.

Fact: Week one was a fluke for Bo Nix. Nix will return to form as Denver settles into the season. The Broncos OL could not block the Chiefs in week one and it was ruinous for the offense.

Fiction: The Tuna Cheesesteak was the best thing on Free Cheese's menu.

15. Tuanigamanuolepola Donny (Kevin)

It's going to take the committee some time to get that spelling down. For now, he can just be Donny. Donny (or Donovan) had a pretty mixed bag in week one. Some of his picks looked like superstars and others like they didn't want to be on the field. First, the good: Jacoby Brissett looked remarkably competent steering the Cardinals offense and the win bodes well for Brissett keeping that job. Chris Olave looked the part of an absolute target hog in New Orleans, racking up the second-most targets of any player this week. Blake Corum looked like it was 2022 when he was laying waste to Big Ten defenses. And best of all, Bucky "Chucky" Irving appears to be back to his rookie year form. Despite all of this, Donny still managed only 83 points. Cooper Rush and Drake London have as much chemistry as Sydney Sweeney and Walter Hudson, Colston Loveland took the day off and Quinshon Judkins struggled to score in that disgusting Browns offense. The good news is the committee's preseason suggestion to improve the quarterback position remains in play.

Fact: Donny should aggressively work the waiver wire for Wentz and/or other QB replacements. Wentz showed he still has some juice filling in for Kyler on Sunday and could provide an immediate upgrade if he remains in the Vikings lineup for several weeks.

Fiction: Colston Loveland is cooked. Can't overreact to one week. Reports out of Chicago all summer were that Loveland was the de facto WR1. We fully expect that to bear out over the course of the season.

16. Work Ass (Sweeney)

Work Ass said he had no chance of repeating. The committee commends his transparency. It's likely he's attacking the minibar with serious gusto this week to drown his sorrows before regrouping for week two. We were high on his star players in the preseason. Not one of McCaffrey, Dak, Ja'Marr Chase or Egbuka delivered on the hype in week one. Devaughn Vele "Chop" was his leading scorer. While the committee was reviewing teams at HQ, the janitor came in to take out the garbage. He couldn't help but take a peek at the screen and damn near booted all over the floor seeing Greg Dulcich and Tre Harris in a real lineup. We had to send the poor chap home. As one of the Bloomfield settlers put it, "He's lucky he won the title last year because this team couldn't do my laundry." Suffice it to say Work Ass might be a fixture at the bottom of the rankings this year.

Fact: Ja'Marr and McCaffrey will be fine. The Bengals offense is notorious for slow September starts and Kyle Shanahan appeared to be making a conscious effort to limit McCaffrey's workload in Australia. That will change as games get more competitive.

Fiction: Fernando Mendoza will start soon. With Tom Brady bizarrely adamant that rookie QBs need time on the bench and Kirk Cousins showing he can be a functional human, Mendoza may ride pine longer than most expect.